Prepflow

DAILY EDITION · FOR TONY DIBBIN

Monday, 19 October 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON	BIRMINGHAM	MANCHESTER	GLASGOW
Light drizzle	Light rain	Light drizzle	Overcast
14° 10°	13° 8°	14° 9°	11° 3°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1 **The head of MI5 has warned about state threats and the growing danger of artificial intelligence in his annual speech.**

Frank Gardner, the BBC's Security Correspondent, has analysed the key takeaways from the intelligence agency boss's address. It outlines what these developments mean for Britain's security landscape.

SECURITY · UK

2 **Three police officers have been injured after a lorry crashed into their vehicle in the early hours of Sunday morning.**

A 36-year-old man has been arrested on suspicion of multiple driving offences, including being unfit through drink or drugs. The incident highlights the dangers faced by emergency services on our roads.

CRIME · UK

3 **A Reform activist has been suspended after allegedly stating that Muslims cannot be considered British citizens.**

The comments were reportedly filmed by an undercover reporter for an ITV broadcast called 'Undercover a Year in Reform'. The incident has sparked debate about integration and national identity.

POLITICS · UK

4 **Health workers in Northern Ireland are running out of patience with the ongoing delay in the Stormont budget.**

The practical impact of the budget delay has become increasingly apparent, with hospital doctors announcing two strikes this week. It highlights the serious consequences for public services.

HEALTH · UK

5 **A fuel leak has spread for more than two miles along the River Taff, prompting a public health warning.**

Public Health Wales is advising residents in the vicinity to keep their doors and windows shut due to the strong smell. Authorities are working to contain the spill and assess its environmental impact.

ENVIRONMENT · UK

02 — SHOWBIZ

What's coming up

1 **Turkish girl group Manifest, who rose to fame on reality TV, are set to play their first UK concert at Wembley Arena.**

It's been a turbulent but incredible year for the group, taking their music to a global audience. Their journey from television screens to a major arena is quite the story.

ON AIR — What's the most surprising journey an artist has taken to reach the top?

MUSIC · COMING UP

2 **Dame Judi Dench has joined the campaign to keep The Archers production in Birmingham, alongside the current cast.**

Cast members have described plans to move the much-loved radio drama as akin to 'Corrie leaving the north-west'. It's a significant show of support for the programme's long-standing home.

ON AIR — How important is it for iconic shows to stay true to their roots and locations?

TV & RADIO · NOW

3 **Marvel fans are about to meet a new Welsh superhero, complete with an authentic Cardiff accent, in the new Disney+ series VisionQuest.**

Lauren Morais will play the villain Lisa Molinari, bringing a distinct Welsh voice to the Marvel universe. It's fantastic to see more regional accents in big productions.

ON AIR — Which regional accent would you love to hear in a superhero movie?

TV & FILM · COMING UP

4 **Welsh singer Jamie Miller says collaborating with an 'Off Campus' star for his viral hit 'Babydoll' gave him 'chills'.**

The track narrowly missed out on the UK number one spot, but Jamie hopes he's 'doing Wales proud'. It's a great example of how online collaborations can create huge hits.

ON AIR — Which unexpected music collaborations have you loved recently?

MUSIC · NOW

5 **The soundtrack for 'The Traitors' is being praised for helping to set the show's unique, campy tone.**

It's not just the treachery and villainy that makes the show so compelling; the music plays a huge part. It's a masterclass in using sound to enhance the viewing experience.

ON AIR — What TV show has your favourite or most memorable soundtrack?

TV & FILM · NOW

03 — SPORT

On the schedule

1 **Manchester United's winless run has now stretched to six games after a 1-1 draw against Leeds.**

Michael Carrick admitted he had his 'headphones on' this week to block out the noise, but the pressure is mounting. Dominic Calvert-Lewin's equaliser means it's their worst run since 2019.

ON AIR — What do you think is going wrong at Manchester United right now?

FOOTBALL · UK

2 **After Daniel Dubois' dominant win over Fabio Wardley, the boxing world is buzzing about what's next for the heavyweight division.**

Dubois' emphatic victory has certainly shaken things up. Fans are already speculating about his next opponent and the future of the sport's biggest names.

ON AIR — Who would you like to see Daniel Dubois fight next?

BOXING · UK

3 **Johan Manzambi's late header secured a victory for Aston Villa against Newcastle, marking Unai Emery's 100th Premier League win.**

It was a significant milestone for the manager, who has enjoyed a successful tenure with Villa. The win keeps them firmly in the mix at the top end of the table.

ON AIR — Which Premier League manager has impressed you most this season?

FOOTBALL · UK

4 **Khadija Shaw scored twice as Manchester City maintained their perfect start to the Women's Super League season.**

City made it six wins from six with a 3-2 victory over Brighton, demonstrating their title credentials. They look incredibly strong this season.

ON AIR — Which team do you think will win the Women's Super League this year?

FOOTBALL · UK

5 **Britain's Sonay Kartal is reflecting on becoming British number one after reaching the final of the Wuhan Open.**

Despite fading from a strong position in a gripping final, Kartal's performance was enough to secure the top spot in the national rankings. It's a huge achievement for her.

ON AIR — Who is your favourite British tennis player to watch right now?

TENNIS · UK

04 — NEWSBRIEF

Quick hits

1 **The simple pleasure of 'writing a proper letter' is experiencing a quiet revival.**
Amidst the flurry of digital communication, many are rediscovering the joy of crafting heartfelt messages on paper, complete with stamps and envelopes. It's seen as a delightful way to slow down and connect more deeply.

2 **A surprising new trend highlights the calming effect of 'watching bread rise'.**
Bakers and non-bakers alike are finding a peaceful meditative quality in observing the slow, magical transformation of dough. Some are even setting up time-lapse cameras to capture the mesmerising process.

3 **The humble 'garden shed' is becoming the unexpected focus of home improvement.**
No longer just for tools, sheds are being transformed into cosy reading nooks, mini-studios, or even tranquil 'retreats' for a bit of peace and quiet away from the main house.

4 **Collecting 'unusual teacups' is becoming a charming, niche hobby.**
People are seeking out unique vintage designs, often with whimsical patterns or intriguing histories. It’s a lovely way to add a touch of personality to your daily cuppa.

5 **There's a growing appreciation for the 'sound of distant church bells'.**
For many, the gentle peal of bells carried on the breeze evokes a sense of tradition, community, and peaceful contemplation. It's a comforting sound that connects us to the past.

6 **The delightful trend of 'decorating your bookshelf like a miniature art installation' is growing.**
Beyond just organising books, people are thoughtfully arranging objects, small plants, and artwork amongst their spines to create visually appealing and personal displays.

7 **A new appreciation for 'vintage board games from the 70s and 80s' is sweeping through homes.**
Families are dusting off classics like 'Go for Broke' and 'Operation', finding joy in their simple mechanics and the nostalgic memories they evoke, often preferring them over modern digital alternatives.

05 — TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q **Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when trying to quickly judge if a new brand of biscuits will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific?**

ANSWER: SMELLING THE PACKET BEFORE OPENING IT, AS IF THAT WILL SOMEHOW GIVE AWAY THE FLAVOUR!

Q **Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to having a particular 'odd routine' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new cup of tea, especially if it's a fancy, artisan one. What is it?**

ANSWER: WARMING THE TEACUP FIRST, EVEN IF IT'S ALREADY A WARM DAY, JUST TO BE SURE IT'S PERFECT.

TALK TOPIC

- **You know how sometimes a particular 'everyday object' just instantly makes you feel a bit nostalgic or takes you back to a specific time?**
  It could be an old ticket stub, a foreign coin, or a pressed flower – something small that just instantly sparks a memory or a story. What's that one object for you, and what story does it tell?

- **We all have those little 'comfort sounds' that just make life better, don't we?**
  Whether it's the gentle pitter-patter of rain on the window, the purr of a cat, or the distant rumble of a train, what everyday sound brings you the most unexpected peace or joy?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY — LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Nature.** Did you know that despite their name, 'ladybirds' are not actually birds, but a type of beetle? And the spots on their backs aren't always indicative of their age!

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Apparently, if you listen very carefully, a contented hedgehog will make a tiny, almost imperceptible purring sound, much like a miniature cat, especially when enjoying a meal of worms.

Prepflow

06 — LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£25 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 — FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The Great Fire of London in 1666 actually helped to eradicate the Black Death by destroying the rat-infested buildings.
- Butterflies taste with their feet, using chemoreceptors to find host plants and nectar sources.
- A group of owls is called a 'parliament', likely due to their wise and serious appearance.
- The world's smallest chameleon, Brookesia nana, can fit on a human fingertip.
- Oxford University is older than the Aztec Empire, with teaching documented as early as 1096.
- The 'king of fruits', Durian, is banned on public transport in some Asian countries due to its strong smell.
- In space, astronauts cannot cry normally because there is no gravity to make the tears fall.
- The inventor of the refreshing 'Rubik's Cube', Ernő Rubik, originally created it as a teaching tool to help his students understand 3D objects.

08 — TODAY'S DAY NOTES MON 19 OCT 2026

On this day

Day 292 of the year, 73 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Aaron (Coptic Orthodox Church of Alexandria); Christian feast day: Blessed Agnes of Jesus; Christian feast day: Aquilinus of Évreux; Christian feast day: Desiderius (Didier) of Auxerre. Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1960 — Dan Woodgate, English musician, songwriter, composer, and record producer
- 1945 — Jeannie C. Riley, American singer
- 1980 — Benjamin Salisbury, American actor
- 1946 — Philip Pullman, English author and academic
- 1957 — Karl Wallinger, Welsh singer-songwriter, keyboard player, and producer (died 2024)
- 1972 — Pras, American rapper-songwriter, record producer, and actor
- 1993 — Hunter King, American actress
- 1963 — Sinitta, American-British singer

THE DAY TODAY

- 1950 — Iran becomes the first country to accept technical assistance from the United States under the Point Four Program.
- 1953 — Ray Bradbury's Fahrenheit 451 is published.
- 2004 — Thirteen people are killed when Corporate Airlines Flight 5966 crashes in Adair County, Missouri, while on approach to Kirksville Regional Airport.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1955 — The General Assembly of the European Broadcasting Union approves the staging of the first Eurovision Song Contest.
- 2003 — Mother Teresa is beatified by Pope John Paul II.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1943 — The cargo vessel Sinfra is attacked by Allied aircraft at Crete and sunk. Two thousand and ninety-eight Italian prisoners of war drown with it.
- 1960 — The United States imposes a near-total trade embargo against Cuba.

- 2005 — Hurricane Wilma becomes the most intense Atlantic hurricane on record with a minimum pressure of 882 mb.

09 — TOMORROW'S DAY NOTES TUE 20 OCT 2026

A peek at tomorrow

Day 293 of the year, 72 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast days: Acca of Hexham; Christian feast days: Aderald; Christian feast days: Artemius; Christian feast days: Caprasius of Agen. Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1984 — Andrew Trimble, Irish rugby player
- 1977 — Sam Witwer, American actor and musician
- 1938 — Dolores Hart, American actress and nun
- 1997 — Ademola Lookman, Nigerian footballer
- 1958 — Valerie Faris, American director and producer
- 1974 — Limmy, Scottish comedian and writer
- 1988 — ASAP Ferg, American rapper
- 1955 — Thomas Newman, American composer and conductor

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1951 — The "Johnny Bright incident" occurs during a football game between the Drake Bulldogs and Oklahoma A&M Aggies.
- 2017 — Syrian civil war: The Syrian Democratic Forces (SDF) declare victory in the Raqqa campaign.
- 1977 — A plane carrying the rock band Lynyrd Skynyrd crashes in woodland in Mississippi, United States. Six people, including three band members, are killed.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 2011 — Libyan Crisis: Rebel forces capture Libyan dictator Muammar Gaddafi and his son Mutassim in his hometown of Sirte and kill them shortly thereafter, ending the first Libyan civil war.
- 1961 — The Soviet Navy performs the first armed test of a submarine-launched ballistic missile, launching an R-13 from a Golf-class submarine.

10 — FORWARD PLANNING · FILM

Coming to cinemas

OCTOBER 2026 · PREVIEW

FRI 23 Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING · SPORT

On the sporting calendar

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